SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #48 · PROSPERITY AND BLESSING

“Being poor means God has rejected me.”

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Where it often comes from

In many cultures, poverty carries stigma, and that stigma can seep into our view of God. If we have been rejected by people, treated as less, or overlooked at church because of money, it is a short step to feeling that God has turned away from us too.

What Scripture teaches

The psalmist says, “This poor man called out, and the LORD heard him; He saved him from all his troubles.” He prays, “I am poor and needy; may the Lord think of me. You are my helper and deliverer.” God “raises the poor from the dust and lifts the needy from the dump.” Jesus began His ministry saying the Spirit anointed Him to preach good news to the poor. Proverbs says, “The rich and the poor have this in common: The LORD is Maker of them all.” God does not reject the poor. He draws near to them.

> *“This poor man called out, and the LORD heard him; He saved him from all his troubles”* (Psalm 34:6).

Also see

> “But I am poor and needy; may the Lord think of me. You are my helper and deliverer; O my God, do not delay” (Psalm 40:17).

> “He raises the poor from the dust and lifts the needy from the dump” (Psalm 113:7).

> “‘The Spirit of the Lord is on Me, because He has anointed Me to preach good news to the poor. He has sent Me to proclaim liberty to the captives and recovery of sight to the blind, to release the oppressed.’” (Luke 4:18).

> “The rich and the poor have this in common: The LORD is Maker of them all” (Proverbs 22:2).

Common self-statements

- God has turned His back on me.
- I am not important to God.
- He prefers people who have more.
- I am on the outside of His blessing.
- I am a disappointment to Him.
- Even God has given up on me.

Common logical errors

- Emotional reasoning: Feeling rejected and concluding that God has rejected me.
- Mind reading: Assuming I know God’s view of me from my circumstances.
- Overgeneralizing: Letting people’s rejection stand for God’s.
- Labeling: Calling myself “rejected.”

Challenging questions

- Who made me feel less because of money, and how has that colored my picture of God?
- What does Scripture say about how God sees the poor?

- How did Jesus treat people who had little?
- What does “Maker of them all” say about my worth?
- When have I sensed God near me even in a hard time?
- What would change if I believed God draws near to me now?

Truth summary

> God has not rejected me. He hears the poor, helps the needy, and lifts them up. I am His, made in His image and loved. My circumstances do not change how close He is.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Poverty
- God, All Loving
- Loneliness
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Refuge/Safety

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Suffering

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God’s companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

The God Who Stays — Matthew West
God’s faithful presence challenges the expectation of rejection and abandonment.

He Knows — Jeremy Camp
Jesus understands suffering and invites people to bring their burdens to Him.

Softly and Tenderly — Kristyn Getty with Vince Gill, Ellie Holcomb and Sierra Hull
This older hymn pictures Christ’s gracious invitation to return rather than hide in shame.

Each morning ask: “If I truly believed God’s truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?”

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Being poor means God has rejected me"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Being poor means God has rejected me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who made me feel less because of money?
- ☐ How does God see the poor?
- ☐ How did Jesus treat those with little?
- ☐ When have I sensed God near?
- ☐ What does being His mean?
- ☐ Where can I find a welcoming community?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God hears the poor.
- ☐ He is my helper and deliverer.
- ☐ He raises the poor from the dust.
- ☐ Jesus came with good news for the poor.
- ☐ The Lord is Maker of us all.
- ☐ I am accepted, not rejected.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Psalm 34:6
  "This poor man called out, and the LORD heard him; He saved him from all his troubles."
- ☐ Psalm 113:7
  "He raises the poor from the dust and lifts the needy from the dump."
- ☐ Luke 4:18
  "'The Spirit of the Lord is on Me, because He has anointed Me to preach good news to the poor. He has sent Me to proclaim liberty to the captives and recovery of sight to the blind, to release the oppressed.'"

A verse I found myself: _____

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Heard and held: Each day, write one moment you sensed God near, however small.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Psalm 34:6 becomes: "Sarah can write: "The Lord heard this poor man and saved him, and He hears me.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Poverty" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- ☐ Name who made you feel less. Write the people or places and forgive them as you are able.
- ☐ Read Psalm 34:6 and 113:7. Say them aloud.
- ☐ Find a welcoming community. Look for a church or group that treats everyone as equals.
- ☐ Tell God how you feel. Pray honestly about rejection and ask Him to show His nearness.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Being poor means God has rejected me": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	God drew near
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Being poor means God has rejected me.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, You hear the poor and lift the needy. When I feel rejected, remind me that I am Yours. Draw near to me, and heal the hurts that people have caused. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.